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JOE & REX SPLODE



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writer

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penciler, inker

BILL CRABTREE
colorist

RUS WOOTON
letterer

ROBERT T KIRKMAN
story editor

AUBREY SITTERSON
editor

cover by
NATE BELLEGARDE and BILL CRABTREE

ATOM EVE & REX SPLODE created by
CORY WALKER and ROBERT T KIRKMAN

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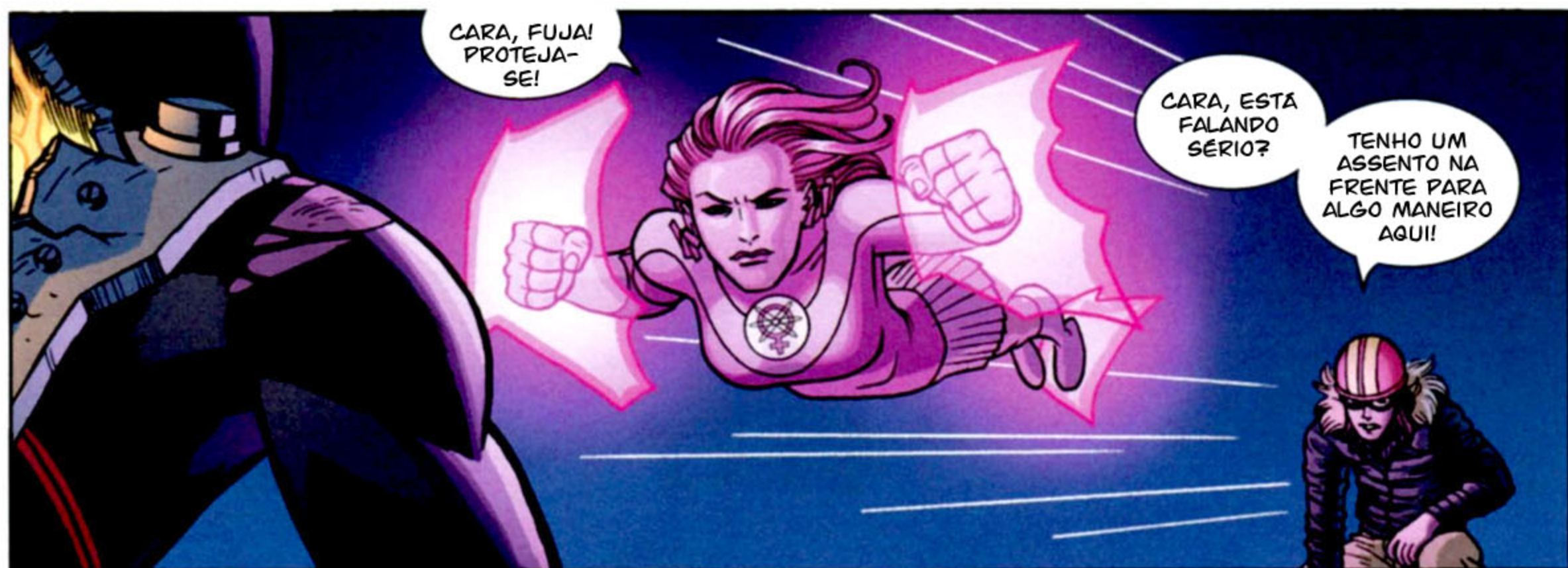
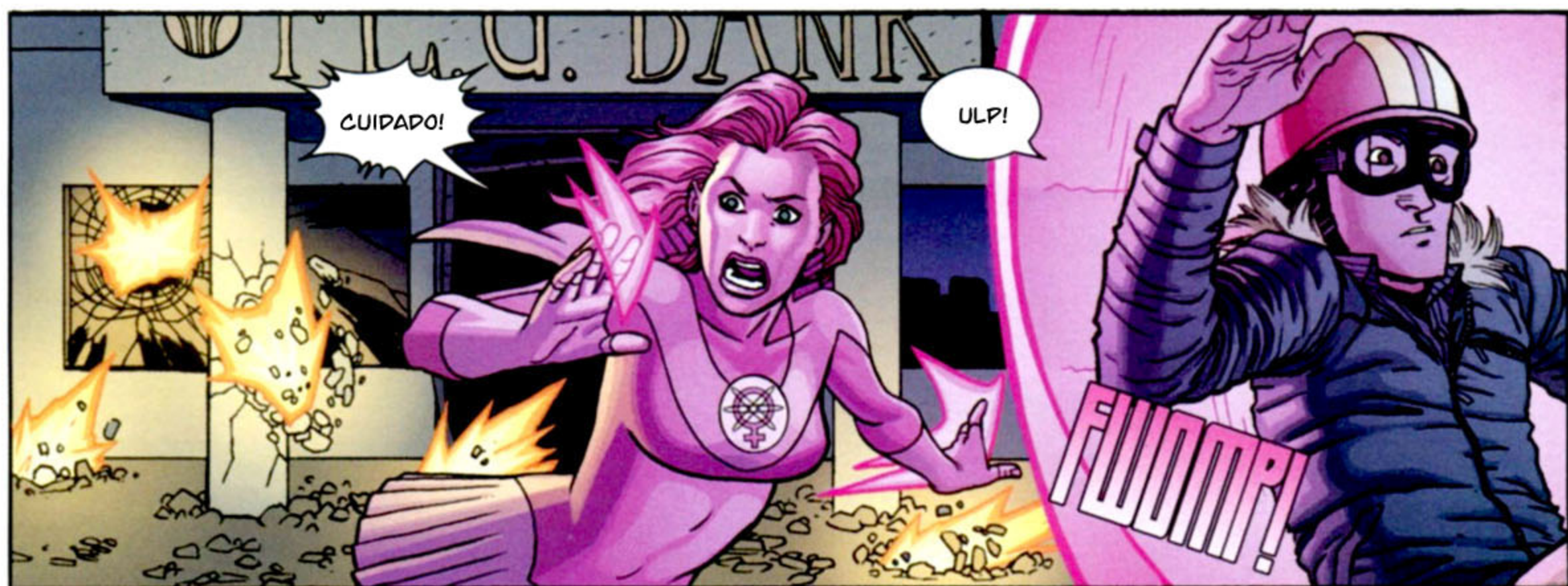
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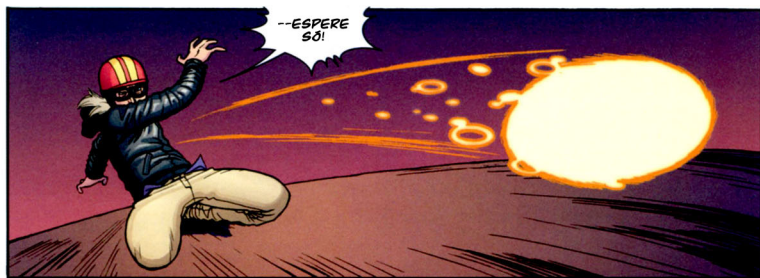
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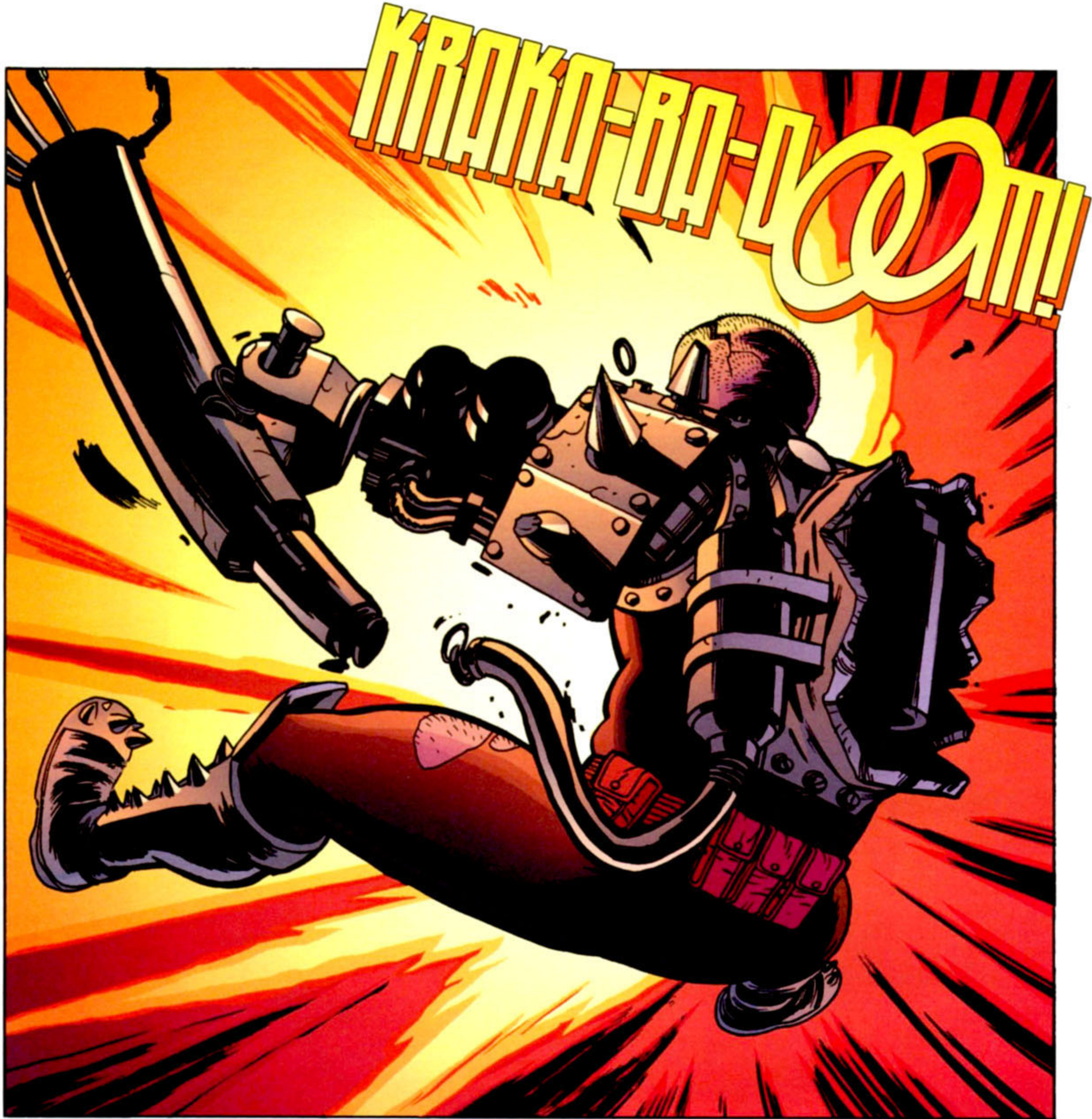
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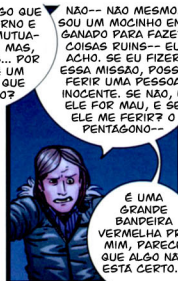
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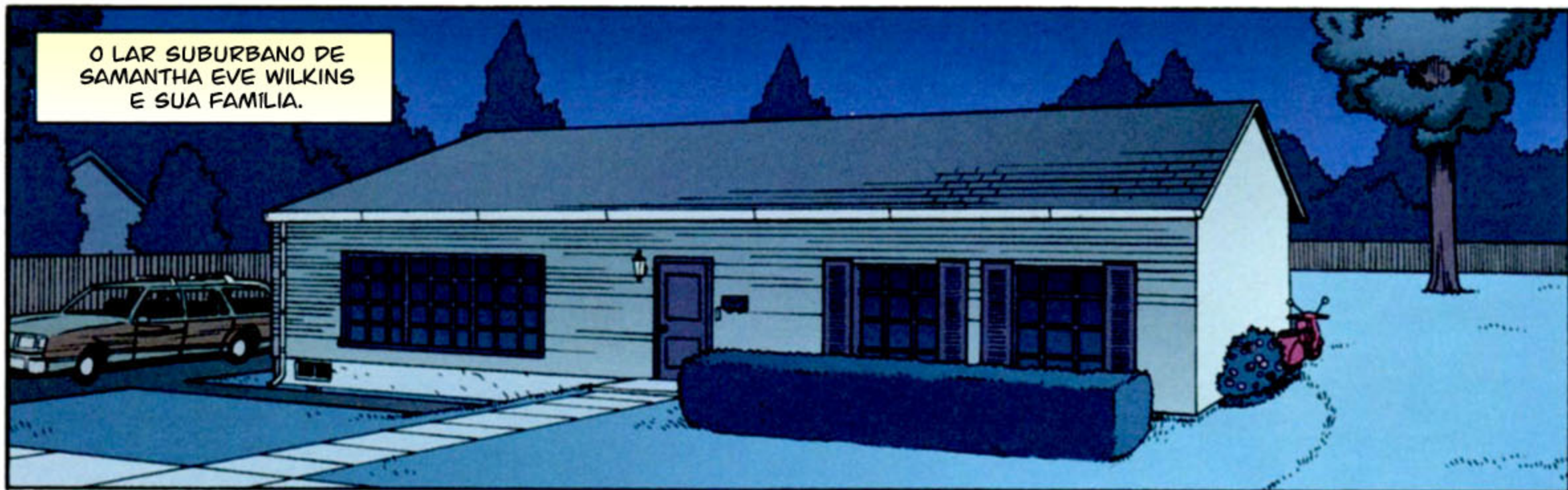












O LAR SUBURBANO DE SAMANTHA EVE WILKINS E SUA FAMÍLIA.



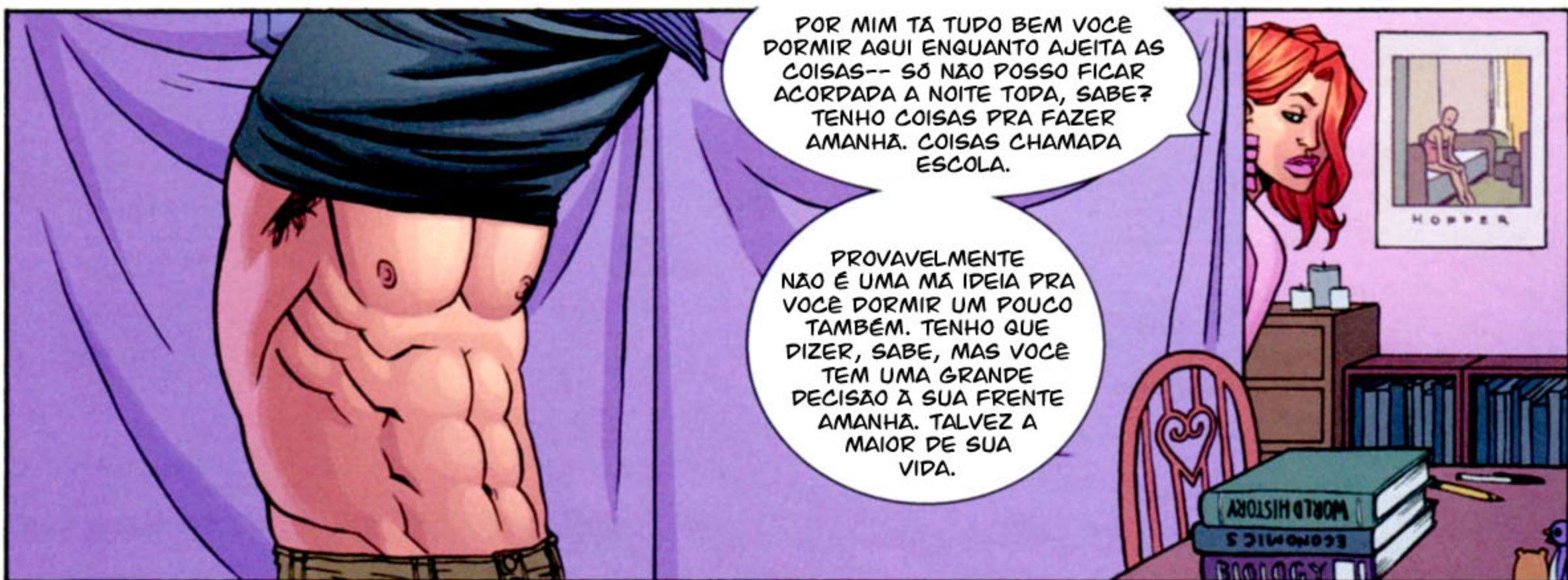
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DIGO, PAIS, CERTO? LOUCURA.

EH, SIM. ACHO QUE SEI O QUE QUER DIZER.

OLHA, DEVIAMOS IR EM FRENTE E NOS VESTIRMOS PARA DORMIR.

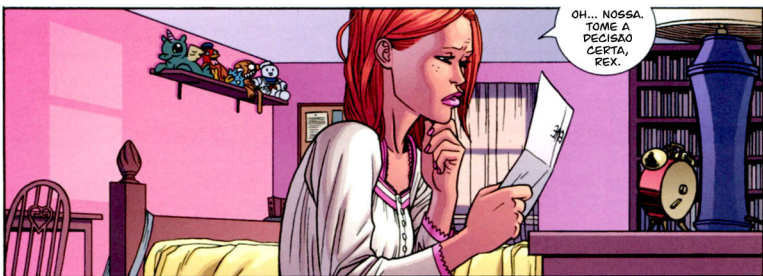
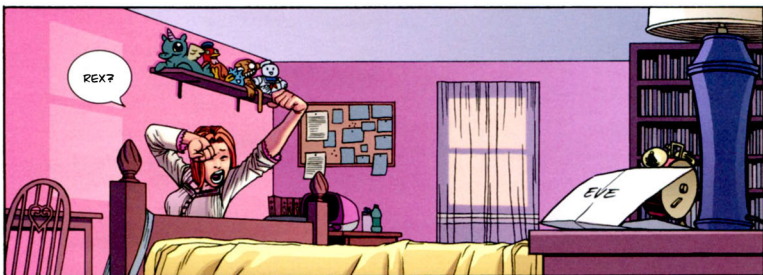
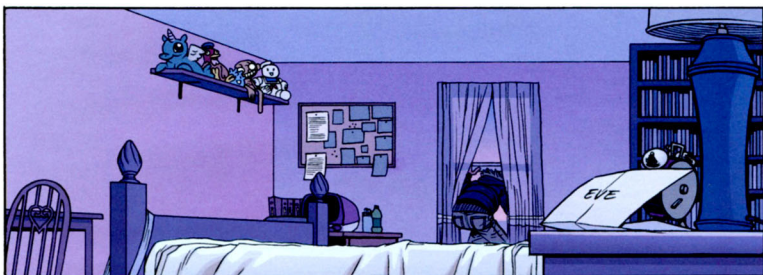
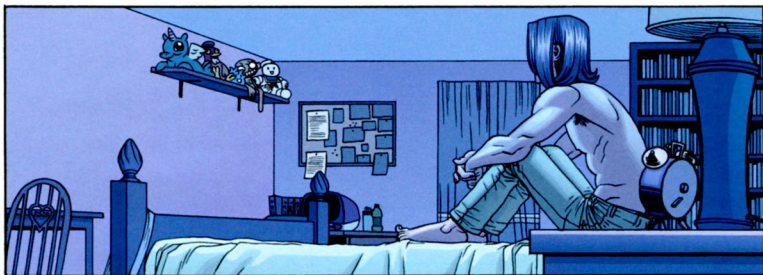


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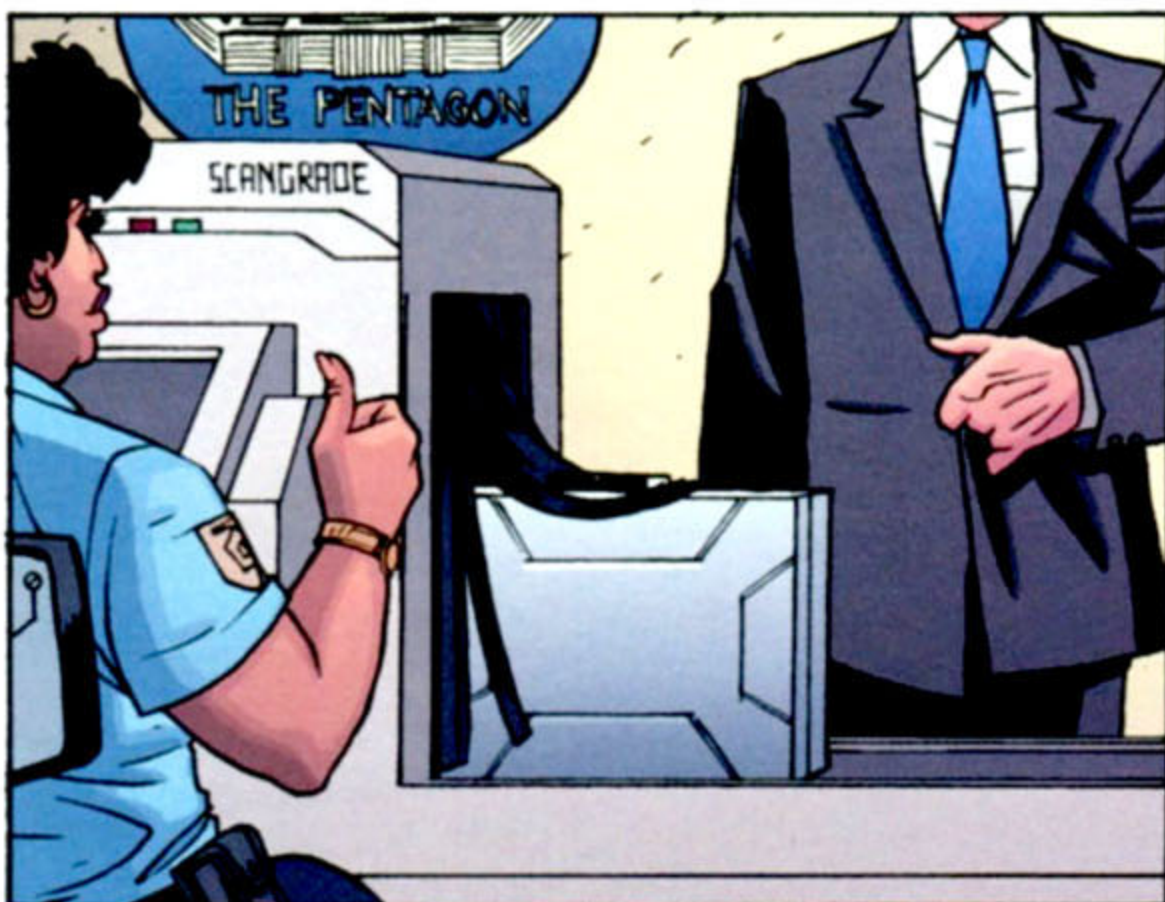
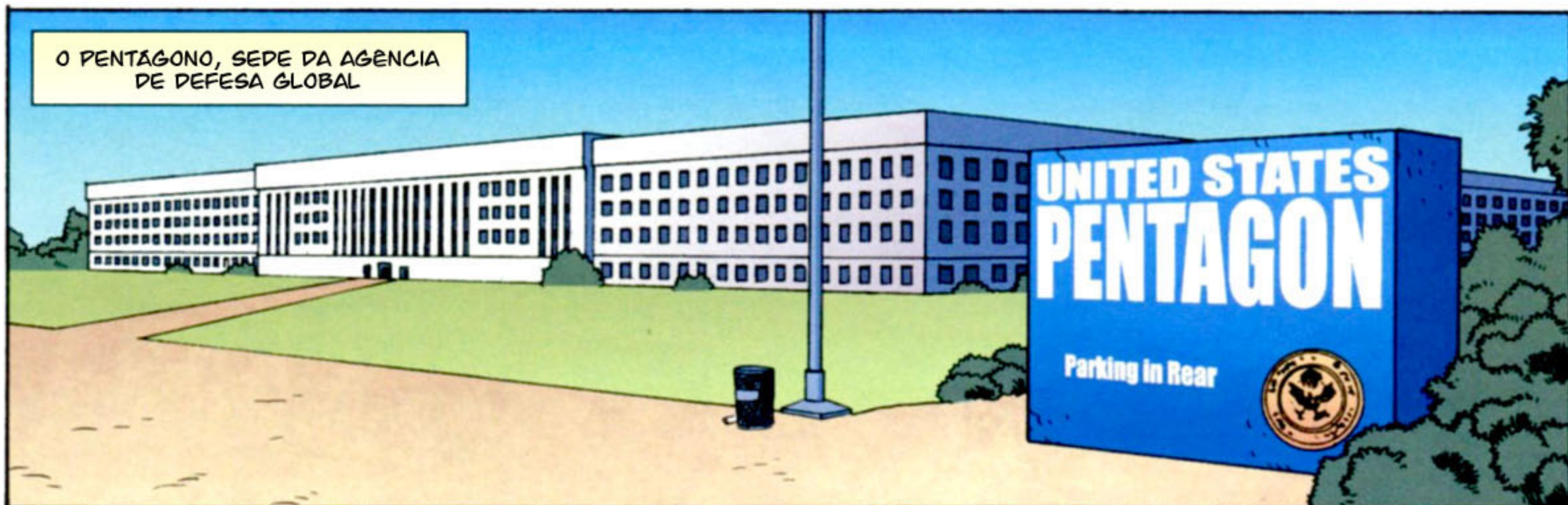
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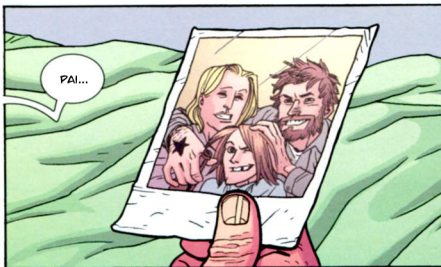
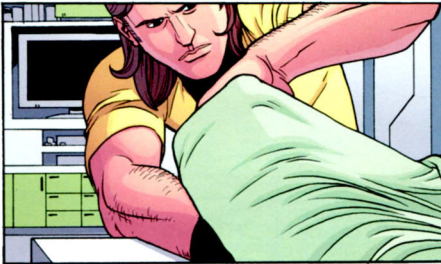
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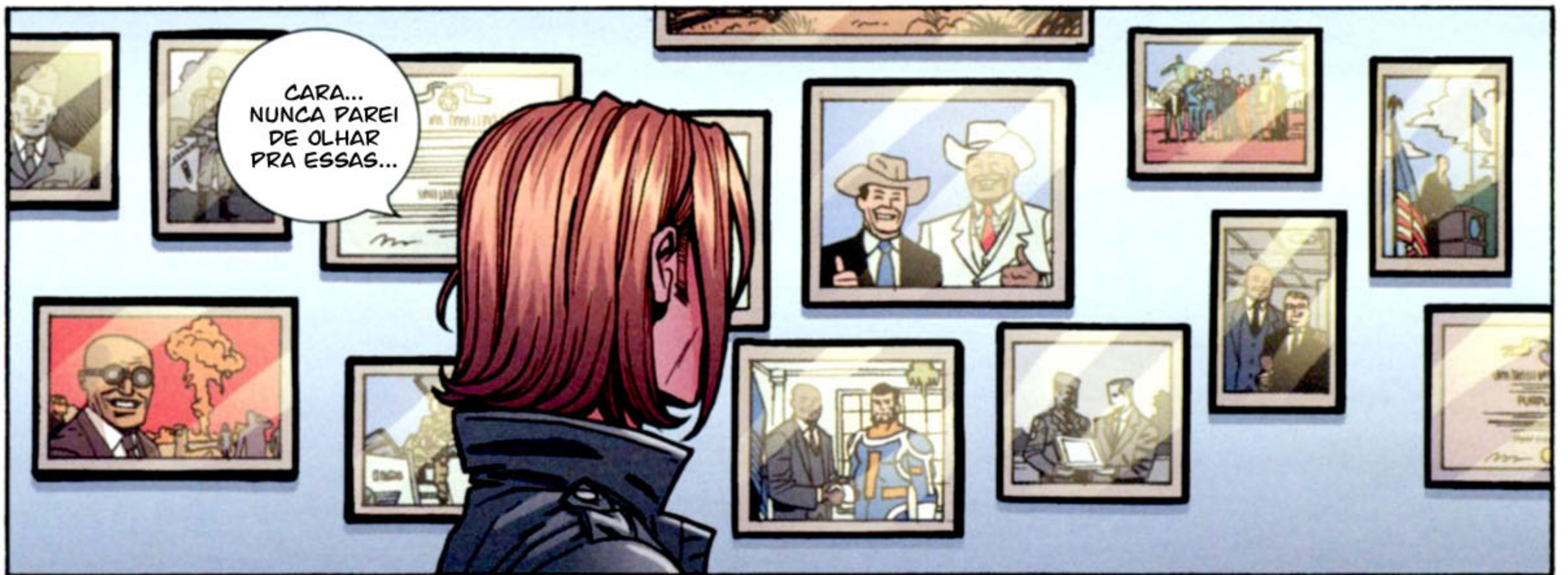
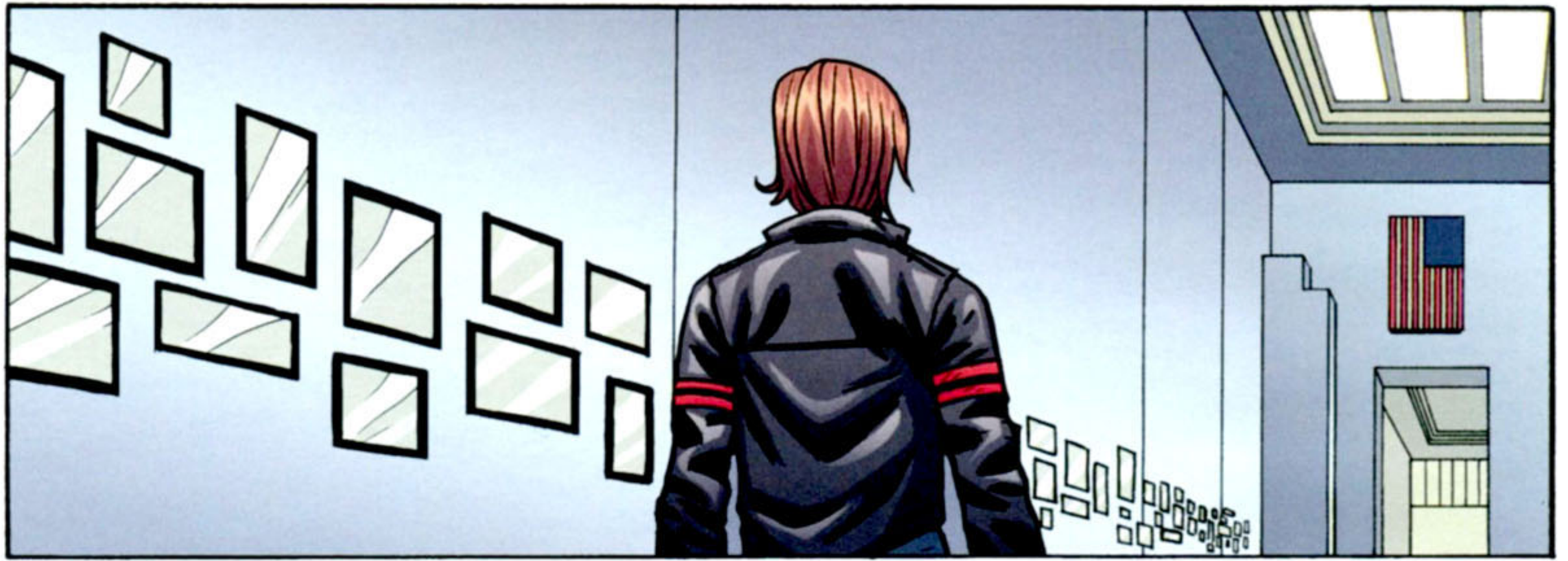


O PENTAGONO, SEDE DA AGENCIA
DE DEFESA GLOBAL



*NÃO SEI QUEM VOCE É MAS ACABEI DE SALVAR SUA VIDA.







BOM DIA, SR. RADCLIFFE. O QUE É ESSA FOTO?



O QUE, 1990? SÓ EU E UNS SOLDADOS QUE FIZERAM ALGUMAS OPERAÇÕES ESPECIAIS COMIGO NOS ANOS OITENTA.



POR QUE? ESTAVA ESPERANDO UM?

ACHO QUE UMA EXPLOSAO LETAL NO PENTAGONO GARANTIRIA ALGUMA COBERTURA.



TA, OK MAS ESSE CARA É MEU--

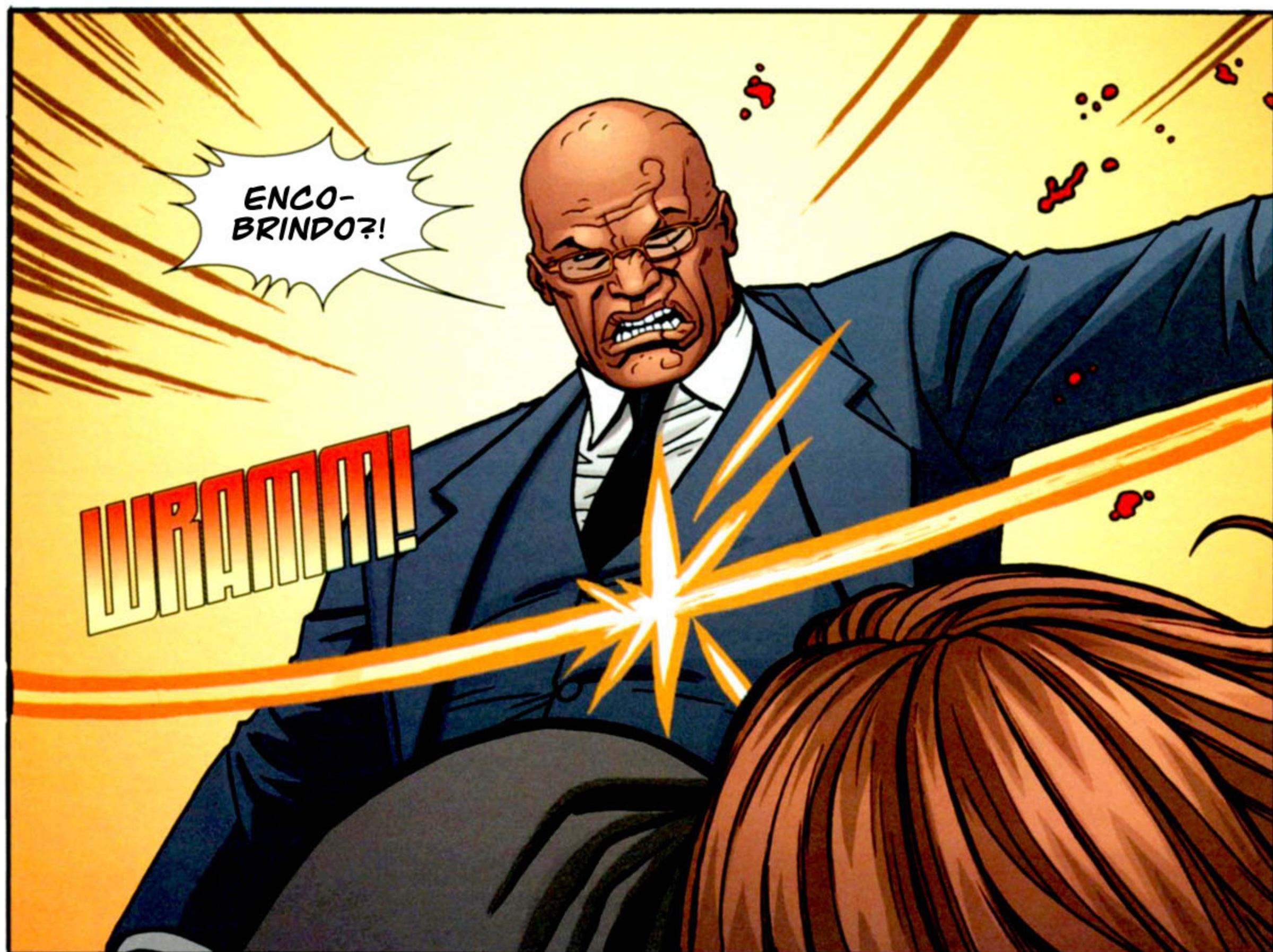
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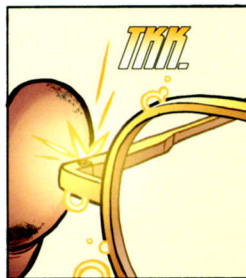
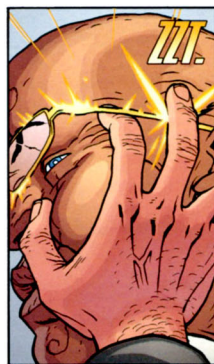


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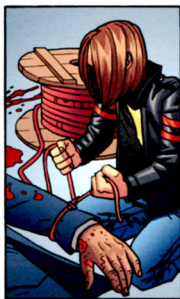
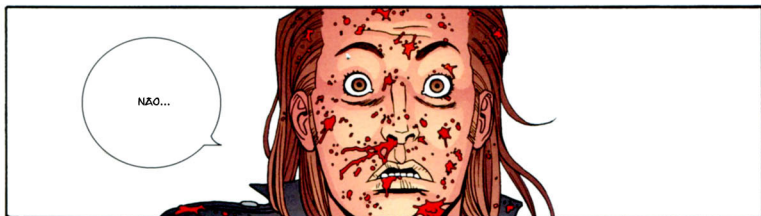
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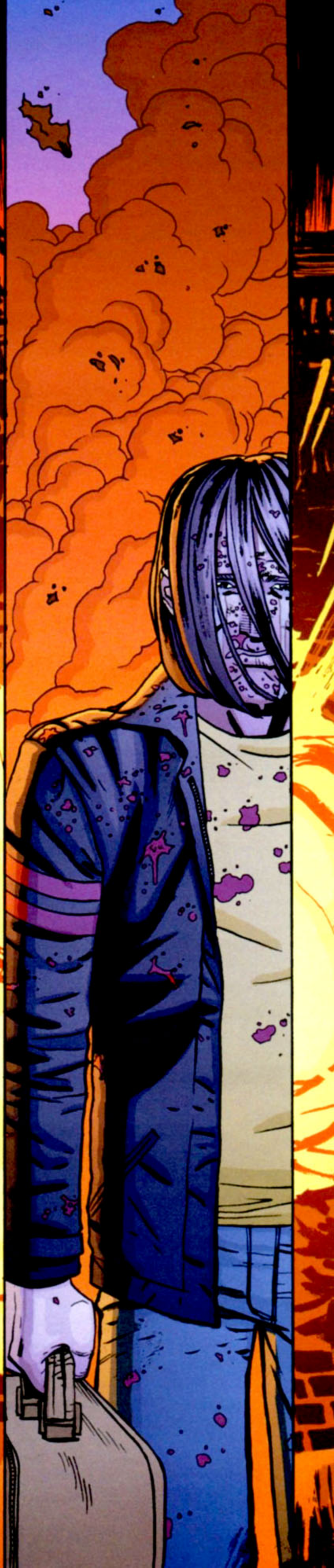


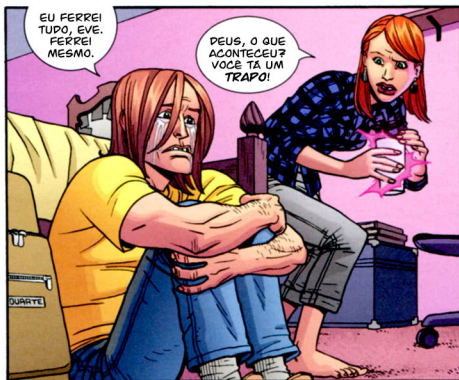
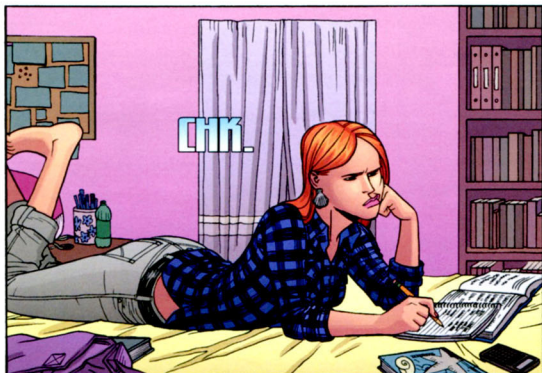




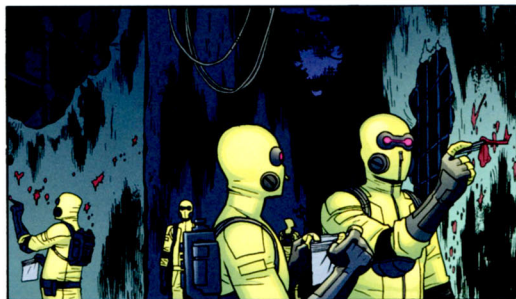
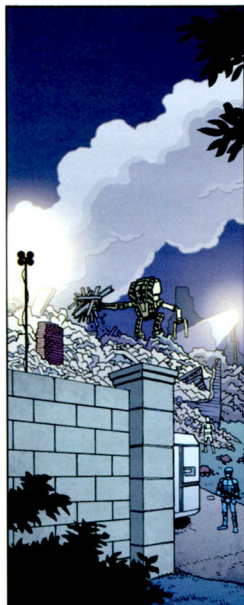
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Send emails to: Invincible@funkatron.com

What up, nerds!

Welcome to Penvincipals Presents! Robert is too busy smoking rolled up hundred dollar bills with Todd McFarlane to do a letters page this time around, so it's me, Benito, responding to letters! You'll just have to pretend I'm a great big guy with a beard and try to make do. *(Benito IS a great big guy with a beard, all--that's why this is funny--Robert)*

First off, thanks to all the dudes who worked on this book with me: Nate, for drawing a man's head exploding in the most hilariously gory way ever, Bill for coloring all the little bits of that man's head, and Rus for putting the appropriately evocative sound effect next to that picture of a man's head exploding. Thanks also to Robert for letting me and Nate play with his toys, and thanks to Cory for giving me high fives when I am sad. And thanks to Aubrey for... the memories, I guess?

Anyway, this is actually my first ever letters column, so let's totally do some letters!

Dear Mr. Kirkman/Cereno,
Well... What to say about issue #1 of *Invincible Presents: Atom Eve & Rex Splode*? First, let me compliment the Bellegarde, Crabtree team-up on this issue. It looks great! The beginning caught me off guard with how ominous it was, even with reading the preview sometime before, but I have to say, I loved the overall turnout of the issue.

I've read a sad story before, but there is nothing more sad than a man selling his son for a steak dinner, as Mr. Radcliffe so plainly put it. I've read everything there is to read about *Invincible* and his journey through young adulthood, and for a long time I've wondered how Rex became who he is (or was) today. So, thank you for finally giving us that explanation.

I realize we are gonna be told more in depth how the lives of Rex and Eve have intertwined. I guess my question is, are we gonna find out why Mr. Radcliffe had the certain vendettas against the people he sent Rex after?

A question for Robert: Why did you find it so important to kill off Rex in the first place? Was it just time to kill someone? I know you have been known for your constant murder of your characters in *The Walking Dead*, but it's clear you're not going that direction with *Invincible*. Was it to save us a love triangle later between Mark, Eve, and Rex? Lastly, is that a scar on Radcliffe's face or just the way he's drawn?

Thanks again for all the great work.

Long time fan,
Bobby

I'll answer for Robert because I am pretty sure he will never read this column. *(Don't be so sure--Robert)* This is no offense meant to you, dear letter writer, it's just that I heard him mumbling something about this being an "ancillary title" and that "Pilot Season isn't going to write itself." Anyway, I don't know why he killed Rex, but I am pretty sure it is your fault. *(To put it plainly, I set up the death in a round about way in issue 34--go check it out--and had to follow through on it at some point. I dug Rex but it just seemed like time for him to go. It, I think, helps Eve's relationship with Mark in a real way--makes it more interesting, and toying him in *The Invincible War* in such a quick way was kind of a play on how there's always one semi-important character to die in the big company crossovers!--Robert)*

As for Radcliffe, this series is pretty much exclusively from Rex's perspective, so we'll learn as much about Radcliffe's motives as Rex does. You can learn a few more tasty details about his background--and his scar (which is TOTALLY a scar)--in the secret origin of Cecil in *Invincible* #50.

Dear Benito n' co., I thought Rex was dead! Now--NOW we get his origin? Okay, well, this is my first time reading your work, and I gotta say: Pretty swell! I mean I don't smell a spin-off or anything, but I did buy it, read it, and liked it. If any *Invincible* character deserves a spin-off, it might be Monster Girl. Just on name alone she's better than Atom Eve or Rex Splode. I might call it something like... I

dunno... Monster Girl and the... Monster Men of America. *(I smell Eisner!--Aubrey)?* Maybe, maybe not. But if Robert Kirkman never used any of my ideas, I don't expect anyone else to.

Sincerely,
Andrew J. Shaw

Holy crap, an Andrew J. Shaw letter. This IS a letters column deflowering.

Rex is dead--in the present. See, this story is a flashback. That means it takes place in the past, when Rex is still alive. That's why *Invincible* isn't in this story; it takes place in the past, before Mark (*Invincible*) gets his powers. Monster Girl (the girl who turns into a monster in the regular *Invincible* series) is also not in it, because this story takes place before she is on the hero scene.

Please write another letter if you get confused!

(I would put money on that happening, the lettering writing... not necessary the getting confused part.--Robert)

Hey Kirk,

Long time reader, first time caller. I love your books and blahblahblah. Enough about that. On to my question: Rex sploded his skeleton. However, in this very first issue they clearly state he can't charge organic material! Am I impatient and you have a perfectly good explanation for this, or is this an ever-so-rare continuity issue? I am assuming the former because you are so good at keeping up with continuity, so I trust you, but to ease my nerdy curiosity, please explain.

Stay Awesome,
Chris Samperi

P.S. I want to be *Invincible* in the movie. Or if you can't get it made, I want to make it and THEN be it! *(They're remaking the Marky Mark vehicle already!--Aubrey)*

Here is for the real, actual, final answer about the skeleton deal: the injections you see the doctor bots giving Rex to increase the density of his muscle fiber also cause an accumulation of mineral deposits in his bones, also for the purpose of strengthening them. There was a large enough proportion of these unnatural mineral deposits in his bones for him to be able to charge them enough for a big boom. I fully meant to explain this within the dialogue for issue one, and then totally forgot. That one's my b.

But honestly, you didn't even TRY for that No-Prize.

(Honestly, this explanation is perfect, but I just wanted to come clean that yeah--that's a bit of a continuity goof--but you know what... I thought him exploding his own skeleton was too good a bit to let something like continuity get in the way! And look--it was unnatural minerals that got in his bones anyway--so it totally makes sense! WOO!--Robert)

Okay, that's all the time we have! This was fun. I should do another letters column sometime.

Maybe next month, when *Invincible Presents Atom Eve and Rex Splode* #3 comes out (my first ever #3!). You should buy it!

*(You should also buy Hector Plasm: Totentanz, the new one-shot by me and Nate Bellegarde that came out last month. You should ALSO also buy the first issue of the all-new ongoing *The Tick* series by me and Les McClaine, which comes out this month!)*

See you in 30, chumps!

--Benito Cereno

*(Chumps? Sheesh. Obviously, you should not actually buy those things that Benito mentioned here. You've got more than enough other things to buy, like *Haunt*, *Image United*, the five *Pilot Season* one-shots I'm doing with *Top Cow* and any number of other things with my name on them. Thanks for reading!--Robert)*

AL SIMMONS RETURNS

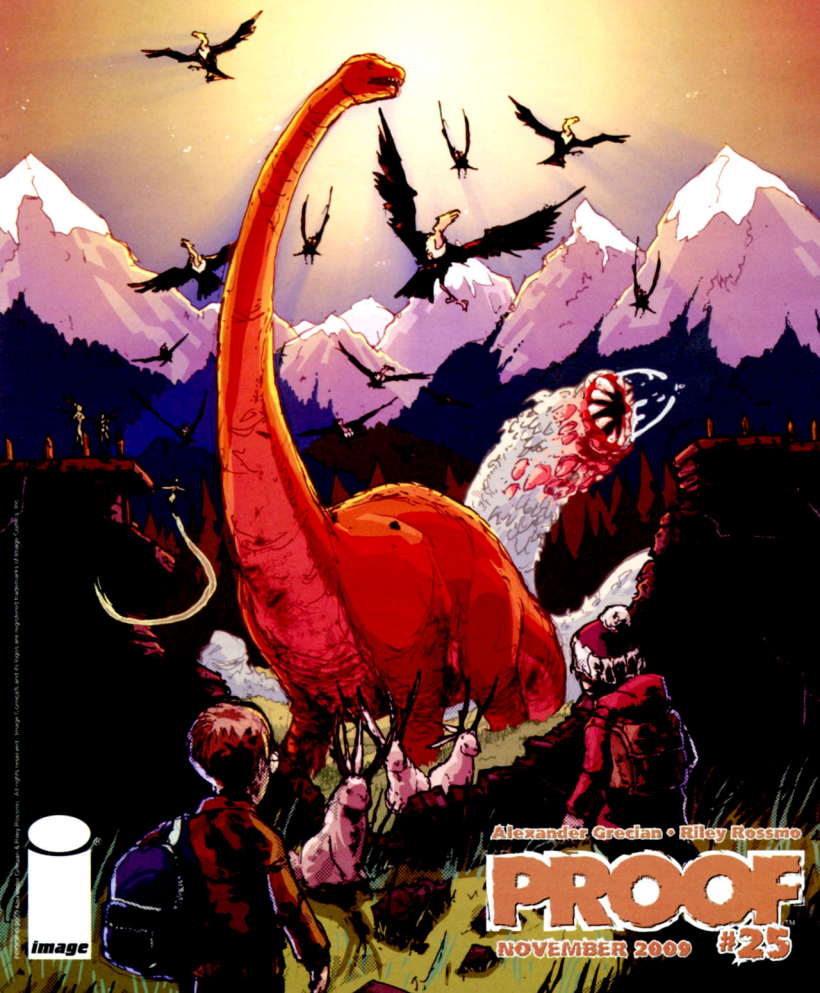


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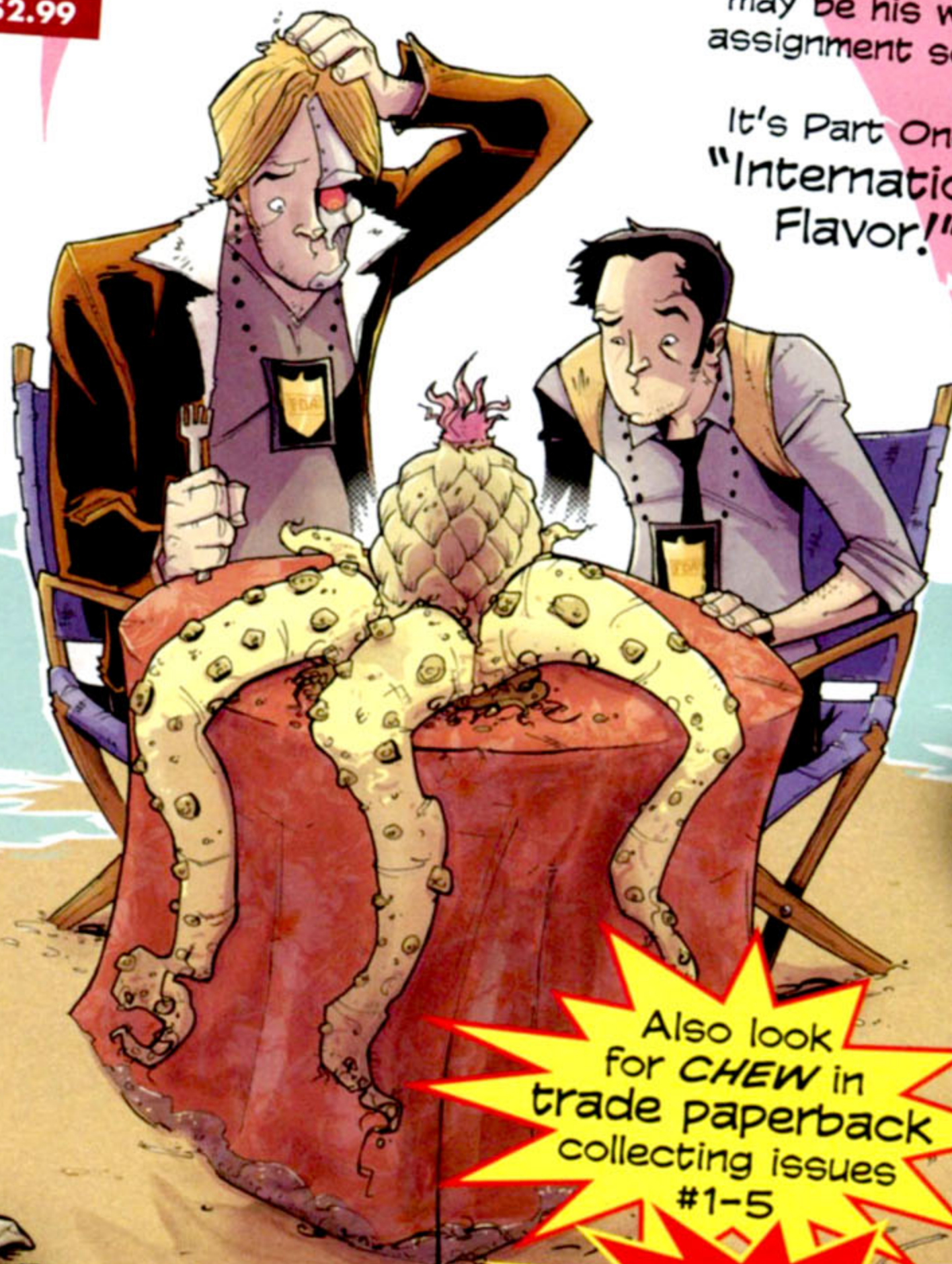
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